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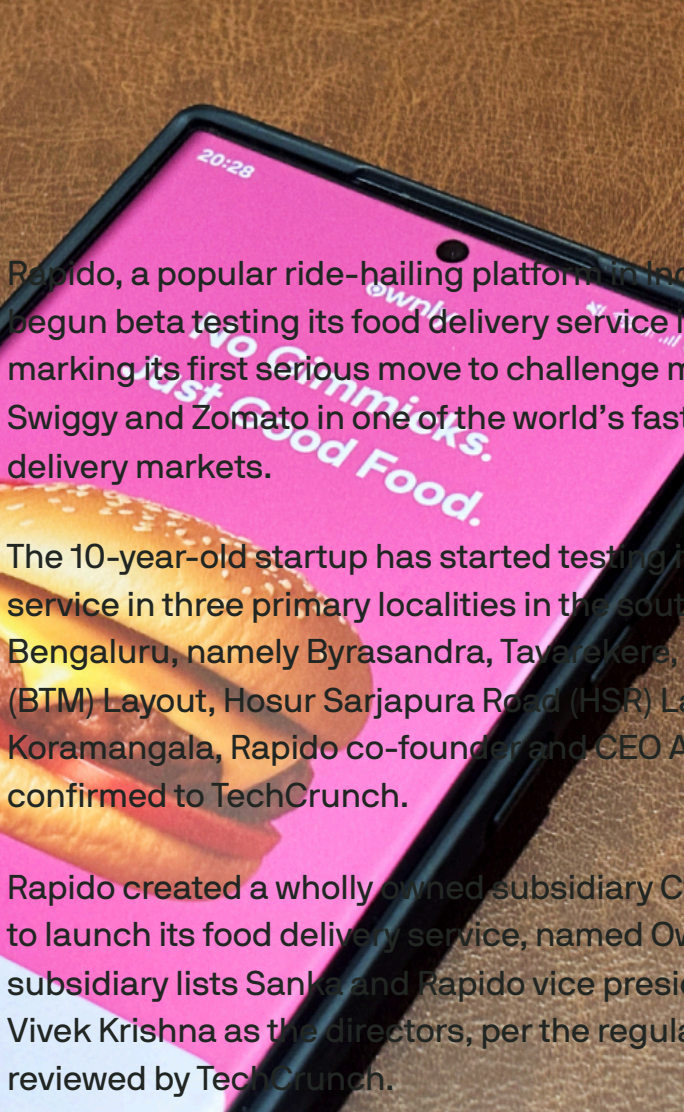
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TRANSPORTATION



India's Rapido begins testing food delivery to take on Swiggy, Zomato



Rapido, a popular ride-hailing platform in India, has quietly begun beta testing its food delivery service in Bengaluru, marking its first serious move to challenge market leaders Swiggy and Zomato in one of the world's fastest-growing delivery markets.

The 10-year-old startup has started testing its food delivery service in three primary localities in the southern city of Bengaluru, namely Byrasandra, Tavarekere, and Madiwala (BTM) Layout, Hosur Sarjapura Road (HSR) Layout, and Koramangala, Rapido co-founder and CEO Aravind Sanka confirmed to TechCrunch.

Rapido created a wholly owned subsidiary Ctrlx Technologies to launch its food delivery service, named Ownly. The subsidiary lists Sanka and Rapido vice president of finance Vivek Krishna as the directors, per the regulatory filings reviewed by TechCrunch.

IMAGE CREDITS: JAGMEET SINGH / TECHCRUNCH

Sanka said there was no specific reason for setting up the subsidiary. However, it may be a strategic move to avoid potential conflicts of interest with Swiggy, which currently holds a 12% minority stake in the ride-hailing startup.

Swiggy recently [confirmed](#) in a letter to shareholders that it would reevaluate its investment in Rapido, citing a potential conflict of interest “that may arise in the future.”

Meanwhile, Rapido's Ownly has also [released](#) its Android app on Google Play that offers food from nearby restaurants at around 15% lower prices than those on Swiggy and Zomato.

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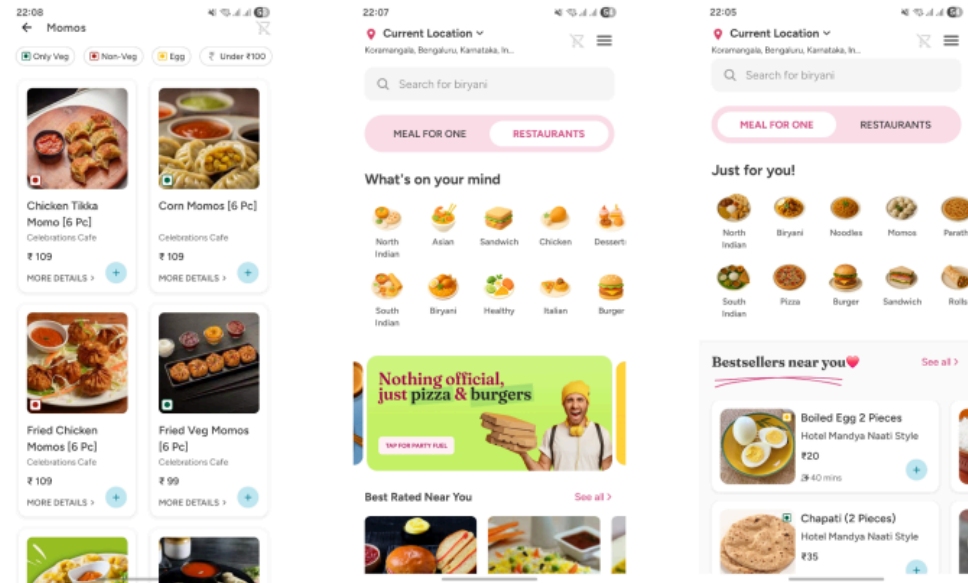
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RAPIDO'S OWNLY FOOD DELIVERY APP.

IMAGE CREDITS:OWNLY

The lower pricing is a result of Rapido's model of not taking commissions from restaurants, which are up to 30% in the case of other food delivery apps, including Swiggy and Zomato, and instead charging a fixed fee per order. The startup [mentioned its fixed-fee approach](#) in a proposal to restaurants in June.



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Rapido has a fleet of around 10 million vehicles, including 5 to 6 million two-wheelers, across India, a person familiar with the startup's business told TechCrunch recently. The company is using its two-wheeler fleet to deliver food — alongside offering its taxi and courier services.

Rapido will avoid showing restaurants located far from customers to reduce fuel costs and delivery times, and will curate menu items on its app to maximize margins while

offering enough discoverability, a Rapido investor told TechCrunch on condition of anonymity.

While handling deliveries for Swiggy, Rapido gained insight into peak hours and high-demand restaurants — the data it would now leverage for its own food delivery service, the investor said.

The agreement with Swiggy does not prevent Rapido from using this data, although it does prohibit the startup from entering into contracts with Zomato or other competitors, the investor added.

Founded in 2015, Rapido began as a bike taxi aggregator before expanding into auto rickshaws, parcel delivery, and third-party logistics. In 2023, it [entered the cab business](#) to take on Uber and local rival Ola. The startup gained traction in this segment with its subscription-based model, positioning it as an alternative to the commission-based approach used by its competitors.

Rapido also [partnered with Taiwanese battery-swapping electric two-wheeler maker Gogoro](#) to deploy its vehicles as bike taxis. Moreover, the recent moves helped the startup boost its valuation and [become a unicorn](#) last year.

India's online food delivery market is [projected to surpass ₹2 trillion](#) (approximately \$23 billion) by 2030, per a report by Bain & Company and Swiggy released last year. Zomato currently [leads the market with a 58% share](#), according to brokerage firm Motilal Oswal, while Swiggy [holds the remaining 42%](#), per Bernstein. Uber was also among the early players in the space with Uber Eats, which it [sold to Zomato in early 2020](#).

So far, Rapido has raised \$574 million in 13 rounds, [per](#) Tracxn. It operates in more than 250 cities and handles over 3.5 million rides daily. The startup counts Prosus, WestBridge Capital, Nexus Venture Partners, and Think Investments, among its key investors.

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Jagmeet Singh

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Jagmeet covers startups, tech policy-related updates, and all other major tech-centric developments from India for TechCrunch. He...

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IMAGE CREDITS: [FLICKR](#)

STARTUPS

The wait is almost over: The 2025 Startup Battlefield 200 list drops August 27

Isabelle Johannessen — 9:22 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Set your alarms. Bookmark this page. Refresh like your future depends on it.

After reviewing thousands of groundbreaking applications from around the globe, TechCrunch is just days away from announcing the 2025 Startup Battlefield 200 — our

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handpicked cohort of the most promising early-stage startups set to take the stage at [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) this October 27-29.

The 2025 Startup Battlefield 200 list will go live, right here, on Wednesday, August 27, at 9:00 a.m. PT.

Whether you applied, referred a standout founder, or just want to see who made the cut, this is the moment you’ve been waiting for. Your name. Your rival. Your next investment. They might all be on this list.

This October marks 20 years that [TechCrunch Disrupt](#) has been shaping the startup world — and we’re pulling out all the stops. For two decades, the biggest names in tech, venture capital, and startups have taken our stage to share their visions and make history. Game-changers like Dropbox, Cloudflare, Fitbit, and Discord got their start in [Startup Battlefield](#) — and this is where the next generation of breakout companies will be born.

Want to see these rising stars pitch live? Hear from top-tier founders and investors? Network with the people shaping the future of tech? [Grab your ticket to Disrupt 2025](#), happening October 27-29 in San Francisco.

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Announcing the winner of Startup Battlefield 200 | Tech...



Salva was far from alone. Out of the cohort of 200 trailblazing startups, TechCrunch editorial selected the [2024 Top 20 finalists](#) who wowed the crowd with their disruptive innovations, live demos, and perfected pitches. Runner-up [geCKo Materials turned heads with its compelling story](#) about how years of research led to a breakthrough innovation in adhesive materials that is disrupting the Velcro industry one impossibly sticky situation at a time.

This year's Startup Battlefield 200 Top 20 finalists will be revealed on Day 1 of Disrupt 2025 (Monday, October 27). You don't want to miss the chance to see these founders battle it out live onstage for the \$100,000 prize and Disrupt Cup. Your incumbent will be there. Your competitors have registered. Don't get left behind — [get your tickets to Disrupt 2025](#).

Mark your calendars and set your alarms — the 2025 Startup Battlefield 200 list drops right here on Wednesday, August 27, at 9:00 a.m. PT. Be the first to see which exceptional startups made the cut.

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Isabelle Johannessen

Startup Battlefield Program Manager

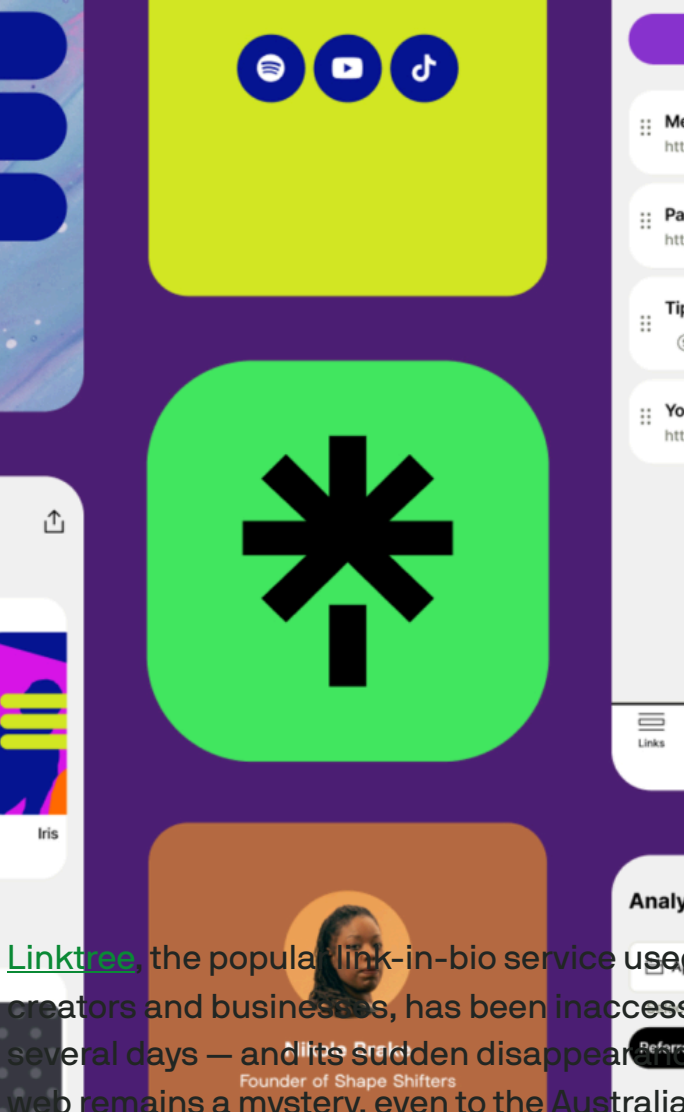
Isabelle leads Startup Battlefield, TechCrunch's iconic launchpad and competition for the world's most promising early-stage startups....

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SOCIAL





Linktree goes dark in India — and the company isn't sure why

Jagmeet Singh — 7:46 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

[Linktree](#), the popular link-in-bio service used by millions of creators and businesses, has been inaccessible in India for several days — and its sudden disappearance from the Indian web remains a mystery, even to the Australian startup itself.

IMAGE CREDITS: LINKTREE

Over the past week, Linktree has been inaccessible in India, with a few users raising the issue on X. Initially, TechCrunch noticed that the site briefly displayed a message suggesting it had been blocked by the Indian government. Later, this was replaced by a generic SSL protocol error. The Linktree app has also been inaccessible in the country.

Founded in 2016, Linktree [became a unicorn in 2022](#) and [surpassed 50 million users](#) in 2024. India has been the platform's fifth-largest market by traffic, accounting for 3.5% of its global visits — or about 7.3 million in July, per Similarweb data shared with TechCrunch.

Linktree's monthly visits in India

(in millions)

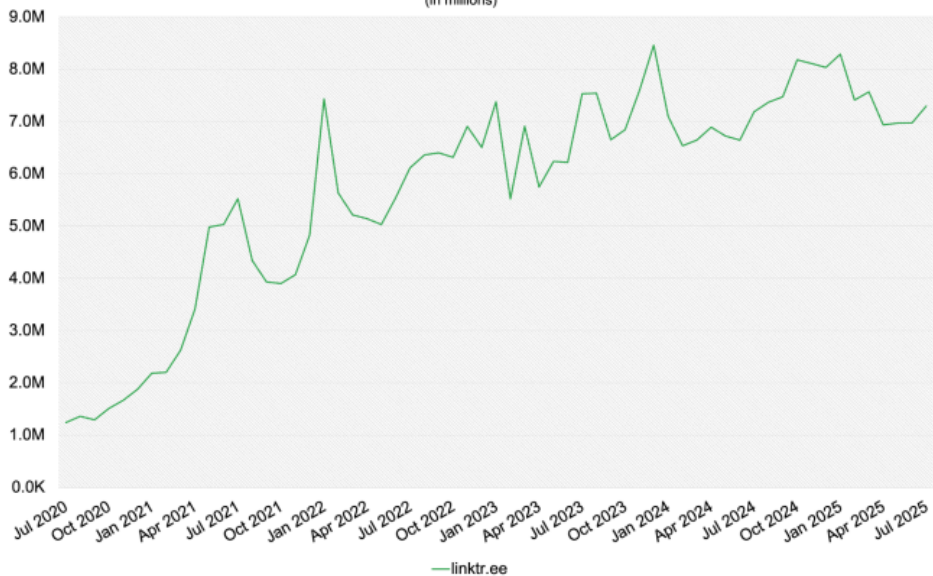


IMAGE CREDITS: JAGMEET SINGH / TECHCRUNCH

Linktree co-founder and CEO Alex Zaccaria told TechCrunch that the startup was looking into the situation. However, the executive did not confirm whether the startup received a communication from Indian authorities on its blockage.

The startup later [posted](#) on X that it was aware of the service outage in India and was “investigating” the issue.

As [reported](#) by the Indian daily The Hindu, the outage is not limited to a specific internet service provider and appears to affect all major networks.

The U.S. remains Linktree’s top market, with 48.5 million visits, followed by Indonesia (32.3 million), Brazil (30.8 million), and the U.K. (9.4 million), Similarweb data shows.

India’s IT and telecom ministries did not respond to emails sent over the weekend.

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